

TECHNICAL INTERVIEWING

CS, IT, ENGINEERING AND DATA SCIENCE COMMUNITIES

Please note that this is a basic overview about technical interviewing. See resources at the bottom of this document to apply your skills.

A **technical interview** helps hiring managers evaluate applicants' problem-solving abilities, communication skills, and depth and extent of technical knowledge. Technical interviews are used for jobs in computing, software engineering, and web developer positions. Technical interviews take the form of coding challenges and are done both on-site and remotely. This includes writing code on a whiteboard, shared Google Doc, shared editor, or within a coding environment selected by the employer (an example of this is CoderPad).

Success during a technical interview does not mean one specific right answer. Instead, the employer is most interested in observing your approach to solving problems and how you apply your understanding of technical concepts/coding skills to situations. Therefore, even if you aren't sure where to start when presented the problem, you can still finish on top because the first part of this interview should be focused on clarifying the problem.

To help the interviewer understand your process, actively jot down ideas, think out loud, and ask questions throughout. There is almost always more than one way to solve the problem given – don't hesitate to share options and analyze the value of alternative approaches as you move through the interview. Keep in mind that most coding challenges are timed, so it is important to be mindful of the clock. Once you complete your process, the interviewer will usually ask follow-up questions focused on improving and refining your code.

Coding assessments sent to applicants prior to a formal interview have also become an increasingly common part of the interview process for technical roles. If you receive an assessment via email, it means the employer views you as a promising candidate. Show them you are serious about their company by completing the assessment in a timely manner – the sooner you complete the assessment, the sooner they will continue with the hiring process for you over your competition.

Prepare using the resources below.

Books

- *Cracking the Coding Interview: 150 Programming Questions and Solutions*, by Gayle Laakmann McDowell – a must have book for anyone completing technical interviews
- *Programming Interviews Exposed: Secrets to Landing Your Next Job*, by John Mongan, Eric Giguere and Noah Kindler

Websites

Primary Websites: Start here. It is recommended that you try at least 1-2 challenges from the below resources each week. Form a group of peers to stay accountable and problem-solve.

- Leetcode - <https://leetcode.com/>
- Hackerrank - <https://www.hackerrank.com/>

Additional Links

Mock interview demonstrated by Google Software Engineers:

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XKu_SEDAykw
- <https://www.freecodecamp.org/>
- <https://www.codecademy.com/>
- <https://www.pramp.com/#/>
- <https://coderbyte.com/>
- <https://codingbat.com/java>
- <https://www.aceainow.com/> (data science)
- <https://seanprashad.com/leetcode-patterns/>
- <https://techinterviewhandbook.org/>

